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It is challenging to know our worth—deep in our bones—and actually believe in it. As children, we accepted our worth without question. We didn't often wonder if we were enough. However, as we grew, we began to question that belief and ask: *Am I really worthy?*

Society has made us believe that our worth is something to be earned, won, or proved. We are expected to be excellent in every area of our lives—our jobs, family life, hobbies, and even our personal wellness. Many of us tend to evaluate (评价) our worth based on things outside us. We tie our worth to our job titles, grades, what's in our bank account, how many friends we have, and what other people think of us. We just keep searching for external approval (外在认可). But no matter what we achieve, something always feels missing. It feels like we're never doing or being enough.

For years, I've kept chasing (追求) a sense of worthiness. In my book, *Calm Within the Storm*, I shared how my deep sense of unworthiness pushed me to try to prove myself. It made me finish five degrees, but even after reaching those goals, I still did not feel fulfilled (满足的). However, my life changed when I realized that I had been enough all along. I no longer needed to prove anything to anyone, especially to the people who told me I was not enough. When I started to see and believe in my own worth, that was the time when I found satisfaction. When I stopped trying to earn my worth, I regained my power and started writing my own story.

Dr. Gabon Maté, an expert, introduces the idea of contingent self-esteem (自尊) and genuine self-esteem. Contingent self-esteem counts on external forces—things you own, followers you have, and likes or approval from others. This dependence on the outside world is why people's sense of worth keeps changing. On the other hand, genuine self-esteem is more fixed. It comes from within and remains complete ~~no matter~~ what happens around us.

We do not need to search outside ourselves to feel worthy. According to Maté, when we regain and hold onto this truth, we're "returning to our inherent (本来的) wholeness".

Our worthiness is not something we need to chase—it has always been within us. By being in this world, our worth is already perfectly complete.

77. The writer talks about a popular statement in Paragraph 1 to _____.

- A. explain the popularity of social media
- B. show the importance of the statement
- C. discuss the meaning of self-worth
- D. introduce the topic of self-worth

78. What can we learn from the book *Calm Within the Storm*?

- A. The writer wanted to get five degrees but failed.
- B. The writer felt fulfilled when he found his worth.
- C. Trying hard to prove himself made the writer feel better.
- D. Writing his own story helped the writer to find his worth.

79. According to Maté, which of the followings is genuine self-esteem?

- A. Mike believes he is popular because he has many friends at school.
- B. Mary thinks she is smart because she gets high scores in tests.
- C. Tina believes she is friendly because all teachers say so.
- D. Jimmy thinks he is good because he truly believes it.

80. Which of the following would be the best title for the passage?

- A. Your Self-worth Lies Within You
- B. Be Careful with Your Self-worth
- C. Give up Your Personal Self-worth
- D. Your Self-worth Differs from Others'